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BASIC LINUX COMMAND USE IN WORK

15 essential Linux commands for WSL (Windows Subsystem for Linux)

How to use this guide: Open your WSL/Linux terminal, type the command shown after the $ prompt, and press Enter. Example outputs are illustrative; your computer may show different names or results.

1. pwd — Print Working Directory

Shows the full path of the directory you are currently working in.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ pwd
/home/student
```

2. ls — List

Lists files and folders in the current directory. Use ls -l for details and ls -a to include hidden files.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ ls
Documents Downloads notes.txt
```

3. cd — Change Directory

Moves you to another directory. Use cd .. to go up one level and cd ~ to return to your home directory.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ cd Documents
(No output; the shell moves into Documents)
```

4. mkdir — Make Directory

Creates a new directory (folder).

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ mkdir projects
(No output; a directory named projects is created)
```

5. rmdir — Remove Directory

Removes an empty directory. It will not remove a directory that contains files.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ rmdir old_folder
(No output if successful)
```

6. touch — Create/Update File Timestamp

Creates an empty file if it does not exist, or updates its modification time if it already exists.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ touch notes.txt
(No output; notes.txt is created if absent)
```

7. cp — Copy

Copies files or directories. For directories, use the -r option.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ cp notes.txt notes_backup.txt
(No output; a copy is created)
```

8. mv — Move/Rename

Moves a file to another location or renames it.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ mv notes.txt study_notes.txt
(No output; the file is renamed)
```

9. rm — Remove

Deletes files. Be careful: rm usually does not move files to a recycle bin.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ rm old_notes.txt
(No output if successful)
```

10. cat — Concatenate / Display File

Prints a text file's contents in the terminal.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ cat study_notes.txt
Example output: Hello Linux
```

11. echo — Display Text

Prints text in the terminal. You can redirect it into a file with > (overwrites) or >> (appends).

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ echo "Hello Linux"
Hello Linux
```

12. whoami — Who Am I

Displays the username of the current user.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ whoami
student
```

13. uname — System Information

Shows system information. Use uname -a for more details about the kernel and machine.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ uname -a
Example: Linux host 6.x ... x86_64 GNU/Linux
```

14. df — Disk Free

Shows disk space usage for mounted file systems. Use -h for human-readable units.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ df -h
Example: Filesystem Size Used Avail Use%
```

15. man — Manual

Opens the built-in manual page for a command, when its manual is installed. Press q to quit.

Use / example: Type the following command:

```
LINUX TERMINAL
student@wsl:~$ man ls

(Manual page opens; press q to exit)
```

Safety notes

• Check the current directory with pwd before deleting or moving files. `rm` permanently removes files in many setups; double-check the filename first. The terminal prompts and sample outputs in this PDF are examples, not a live recording from your computer.

WSL means Windows Subsystem for Linux. These commands work in most common Linux distributions, though manual pages may need to be installed.